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China’s secret plan to take over the world

WHILE we were busy debating Lisa Wilkinson, China quietly announced its disturbing plans to take over the world.

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Chinese President Xi Jinping during his three hour speech. Picture: Lintao Zhang/Getty Images *Source:Getty Images*

A FUNNY thing happened this week. While Australia was busy debating the feminist implications of Lisa Wilkinson's pay packet and coming to grips with the fact solar panels didn't work very well at night, China quietly announced it was going to take over the world.

In a speech on Wednesday to the Chinese Communist Party Congress in Beijing's Great Hall of the People, President Xi Jinping said, according to *The Guardian*, "it was time for his nation to transform itself into 'a mighty force' that could lead the entire world on political, economic, military and environmental issues".

That's quite an ambition.

The Party Congress is basically China's Parliament except that it only meets once every five years and only has one party. Think of it as Question Time but without any questions.

Perhaps unsurprisingly therefore, Xi Jinping's speech went for no less than three-and-a-half hours – which had several brave cadres looking at their watches but was at least mercifully brief compared to the speeches of Chairman Mao that went on for days.

Indeed, it is somewhat comforting to know that even in 2017 communists still love nothing more than incredibly long speeches and five-year plans.

> *Jiang Zemin checked his watch 10 times in Xi speech before I lost count 00:45, 01:25, 01.35, 01:40, 01:43, 01:50, 01:55, 01:59, 02:10, 02:19*
> *pic.twitter.com/sAbhC1U9TC*
> *— Neil Connor (@neilaconnor) October 18, 2017*

By way of perspective, I once went to a play at the Sydney Opera House in which the entire text of *The Great Gatsby* was read aloud and that took seven hours. In other words Xi's speech was half the length of a novel but with only a quarter of the character development.

It was also quite literally delivered quietly. Let's face it, when you're the supreme leader of 1.4 billion people everyone knows you're carrying a pretty big stick.

But carefully placed within those thousands of soft words is a clear message that will change the world as we know it today. And rest assured China wants us to hear it.

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